

Short Story

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December 18, 2025

Dexter woke up one day, this day initially being no different from any other in the 15 years he worked at Miamo Metro Police Department. He got dressed, brushed his teeth, prepared his coffee, and nostalgically caressed his blood slides. However, when he arrived at his lab, he saw a new man there, who was placing a box of items on his desk. When Dexter saw this, he approached his best-friend Angel and asked him who this new man was. "James Doakes," Angel replied, "He's ex-special ops. No one knows why he was transferred here though." Dexter thanked Angel and returned to his lab, feeling wary about this potential new threat. Knowing that he had a lot of work to do on the latest Ice Truck Killer killing, he decided to not dwell on it for too long. That night, Dexter vets a potential target to ensure that they are guilty. A few days later, all of Miami Metro Homicide, including Dexter, attend another briefing on the Ice Truck Killer investigation. Captain Laguerta once again states that he is the most prolific serial killer in Miami history, as far as the police are aware anyway, having killed 7 people in the last 5 months. Dexter slightly smiles to himself as she says this, thinking that it's somewhat funny how "prolific" they think this killer is, while they are entirely unaware that they are sitting in the room with the most prolific serial killer in world history. After the briefing, though, he knows that he must sabotage the investigation and eliminate the Ice Truck Killer. First, he needs to kill the pedophile that he's been stalking. When Dexter gets off work that day, he goes to Rita's house to spend time with her and the kids until around sunset, when he tells them that he's going back home and changes into his kill outfit. He then drives to and parks near the pedophile's house, lockpicks the back door, and hides in the shadows, waiting for him to come home. Nearly an hour later, the man arrives and prepares to watch television; however, just as the man sits on the couch and turns the TV

on, Dexter chokes him with his left arm and injects him in the right side of his neck with M99, an animal tranquilizer approximately three thousand times more potent than morphine, which Dexter uses for all of his kills. The man is startled and is easily overpowered by Dexter. Dexter then uses the next few hours to set up his kill room in an abandoned cabin in the woods, setting plastic wrap up over all of the walls and items in the room, wraps the man to his central island from head to toe with the rest of the plastic wrap, and makes the man breathe smelling salts to wake him up. The man instantly jolts awake, and Dexter quickly stands to confront him. "Hello, Mr. Diaz," Dexter said in a monotone voice, staring into Mr. Diaz's eyes. Diaz doesn't respond immediately, instead examining the room, which is dark and decrepit, with a single flickering light bulb illuminating the room. His fear amplified by Dexter's shadowy appearance, Diaz stammered "Wh.. Why are you doing this to me? I.. I didn... I didn't do anything to you!" Dexter, angered by Diaz's actions, walks to his right side. "Hey, wait, what are you doing?", Diaz nervously interjected; however, Dexter ignores him, grabs his neck, and twists it to face the pictures of the children he assaulted. "But you did unspeakable things to these kids," Dexter said. "What? No, I have never seen them before in my life, I swear!" Dexter grabbed one of his knives and gently slid it across his neck, saying "I have seen the photos on your laptop of the kids, from before you decided to kidnap and rape them." Diaz, feeling the cold, sharp steel nearly slicing his neck, regretfully admitted to his actions in a desperate attempt to empathize with Dexter, saying "Okay, okay, I did. But I'm like you," he said with a nervous smile, "We both have urges that we can't control! I had to, I'm sure you understand that, right?" "And for that, I'm sorry, but what you did is inexcusable, especially to children. I could never do something like that to a child; I live by a code, my father's code, and only criminals who evade the justice system deserve my table." "Please don't kill me. I won't tell anyone, and I.. I won't even do it anymore, I promise!", Diaz replied, pretending to be sorry. Lastly, Dexter ended their discussion, saying "People like us, we don't change; we are who we are." After he said this, Dexter put a cloth in Diaz's mouth to prevent him from screaming, walked up to Diaz's head from behind, grabbed his scalpel, and slit his cheek, then aspirating some of the blood into a syringe and pushing it into the center of his two glass blood slides, pushing them together to make another trophy for his collection. Finally, Dexter grabbed his cleaver and dismembered Diaz alive, ending with his head. Now having to clean up the kill room, he put Diaz's body parts in separate heavy duty

trash bags, tore down the plastic wrap, and grabbed his knives. Once he was done deconstructing the scene, he brought it all to his boat and dumped it into the ocean after he sailed far away from land. Dexter arrived back at his apartment by three A.M., put Diaz's blood slide in his box behind the AC unit, and squeezed out every minute of sleep that he could. Early in the morning, he awoke to someone banging on his door violently. He sleepily walked to the door, unsure of who to expect; to his surprise, it was his sister Debra. "Dex, I think I figured it out!", she said excitedly with her hands in her hair and her fingers on her scalp. Dexter lays his right arm on the door frame, struggling to stand from exhaustion, and replies "Figured out what?" "The Ice Truck Killer, I think we've got him!" Dexter's eyes instantly focus on Deb, like a predator who caught his prey in a vulnerable position. "Hurry up and meet Laguerta. She'll catch you up; I need to get back." Bloodlust fills Dexter's mind as he gets closer to killing his true target. He rushes to get dressed as quickly as he can and rushes to work. Rushing into Miami Metro, he takes the elevator to the homicide office's floor, and sees Lieutenant Maria Laguerta instructing the rest of the team, several people on each side of her. Maria and Dexter lock eyes, and when he approaches the rest of the team, he curiously asks "What's going on? Deb said we might be able to catch the Ice Truck Killer?" "It's possible." Maria replied comfortingly, "We think we found where he dumps his bodies." "Really? How?" "Some anonymous caller. We have people trying to find out who it was, but for now we're sending a team there to check it out. You're with Doakes and Masuka." Dexter then looks at Doakes, nods, and smiles awkwardly, still unsure of what to think about this new coworker. He did attempt to research Doakes personally, but it proved unfruitful because of his extended life in undercover ops. Nevertheless, he went to his lab to grab his blood analysis kit and drove to the crime scene. It's a small refrigerated warehouse owned by a large company in the city. Dexter met up with Masuka and Doakes and entered the facility to meet the rest of the Miami Metro forensics team. The entrance to the building is secured by barrier tape, which they quickly bypass by flashing their badges and laminates

they always had, until one day during a crime scene investigation, Doakes began to realize how excited Dexter gets when describing crime scenes, and how Dexter acts around people as if it's all an act. Meanwhile, Miami Metro is hunting the Ice Truck Killer, the only currently known serial killer in Miami. In secret, Doakes stalks Dexter at night in an attempt to find what he is hiding, for Doakes knows that Dexter is connected to the Ice Truck Killer

because of his many unexplainable interactions with the Ice Truck Killer. Unaware of what Doakes is doing, Dexter kidnaps a serial pedophile and sets up his kill room in a secluded building. Doakes is following him, though, and immediately before Dexter plunges his glistening knife into the man's heart, Doakes interrupts Dexter, gun in hand, telling Dexter to surrender. Dexter pretends to surrender, but when Doakes approaches him to handcuff him, Dexter fights back, overpowering Doakes, injects him with M99, and puts him in his vehicle. Putting his current kill on hold, Dexter drives to an abandoned cabin in the woods, sets up a steel cage, and locks Doakes in it. Dexter then returns to his kill room to finish the kill, and returns to his cabin. By this time, Doakes is awake and begins to talk to Dexter, trying to convince him to turn himself in, or to let him go. Dexter initially wants to kill Doakes as an easy solution, but it would break his father's code which states that Dexter should never kill an innocent person, which Doakes is. "The first rule of the code is to never get caught." Dexter thought to himself nervously, unsure of what he could do. Ultimately, Dexter decides to make the Bay Harbor Butcher's existence known to Miami Metro, and to frame Doakes as the Bay Harbor Butcher, releasing Doakes afterward for the justice system to handle.